

Skills

Applying a Nasal Cannula or Face Mask

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Checked the details of the health care provider's orders. Verified the oxygen delivery method, flow rate and duration of therapy.	☐	☐	☐	
Gathered the necessary equipment and supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene, donned gloves and personal protective equipment (PPE) (if needed) and provided for the patient's privacy.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced self to the patient and family.	☐	☐	☐	
Identified the patient using two identifiers. Compared identifiers in the patient's MAR/medical record with the information on the patient's identification bracelet.	☐	☐	☐	
Explained the procedure to the patient and ensured that he or she agreed to treatment.	☐	☐	☐	
Assessed the patient's respiratory system, including respiratory rate, sputum production and lung sounds. Observed patient for behavioral changes, decreased LOC, and dizziness. Assessed skin of the nose and ears. Checked oxygen saturation and ABGs if available.	☐	☐	☐	
Low-flow oxygen therapy:	☐	☐	☐	
1. Attached the oxygen delivery device to the oxygen tubing, and attached the tubing to the oxygen source adjusted to the prescribed flow rate.				
2. When an oxygen flow rate >4 L/min had been ordered, applied a humidified oxygen source.				
3. Positioned a nasal cannula: placed the tips in the patient's nares, and adjusted the elastic headband or plastic slide on the cannula so that it fit comfortably and snugly.				
4. Maintained sufficient slack on the oxygen tubing. Secured the tubing to the patient's clothing if necessary.				
5. Observed for proper functioning of the oxygen delivery device:				
1. Nasal cannula: positioned properly in the nares.				
2. Reservoir nasal cannula, such as the Oxymerizer: positioned beneath the patient's nose or hung as a pendant.				
3. Simple face mask: Applied mask over the patient's mouth and nose to form a tight seal.				

4. Partial rebreathing mask: Applied mask over the patient's mouth and nose to form a tight seal; ensured reservoir bag remained partially inflated on inspiration.
5. Nonrebreathing mask: Applied mask over the patient's mouth and nose to form a tight seal; ensured reservoir bag remained partially inflated on inspiration.
6. Venturi mask: Applied mask over the patient's mouth and nose to form a tight seal; ensured the appropriate port was selected.
7. Face tent: Applied the tent loosely under the patient's chin and over the mouth and nose.

High-flow nasal cannula oxygen therapy:

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1. Positioned the nasal cannula on the patient's face and adjusted the head strap to fit. Followed the manufacturer's instructions for application.
2. Ensured proper positioning of the cannula tips in the patient's nares (curved cannula tips pointed downward). Maintained enough slack on the oxygen tubing for patient movement.
3. Reviewed the high-flow oxygen delivery device settings, use of humidifier and heater, and alarms with the respiratory therapist.
4. Verified that the oxygen delivery device was functioning properly.

Confirmed that the oxygen source and flow meter have been set up properly and calibrated to deliver oxygen at the prescribed rate. Ensured that the ball on the flow meter was even with the number of L/min ordered.

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Documented respiratory assessment and all actions related to oxygen administration.

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Checked the cannula/mask every 8 hours or according to agency policy. Kept the humidification container filled with water at all times.

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Monitored the patient's pulse oximetry and ABG levels if needed.

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Helped the patient into a comfortable position, and placed toiletries and personal items within reach.

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Placed the call light within easy reach, and made sure the patient knew how to use it to summon assistance.

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Raised the appropriate number of side rails and lowered the bed to the lowest position.

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Discarded supplies, removed PPE, and performed hand hygiene.

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Documented and reported the patient's response and expected or unexpected outcomes.

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Learner: _____

Signature: _____

Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____